
Final Approval Documentation

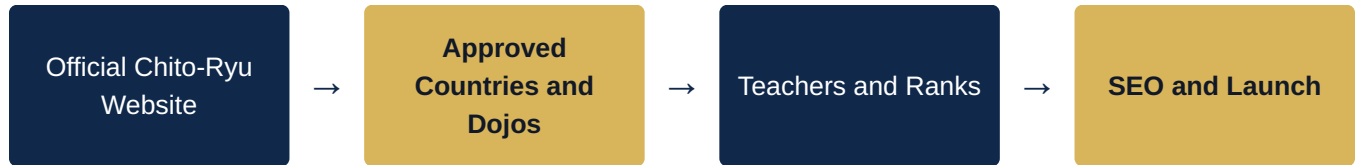
Prepared for	Sensei Michael Noonan
Prepared by	Ross
Website domain	chitoryukaratedo.com
Build support	Adrian for SEO coordination, Gil for UI/UX design
Purpose	Approval to proceed with the international Chito-Ryu website build

I am keeping this build focused. The first website will give Chito-Ryu one official international home online, with a clear directory, leadership pages, teacher listings, Japanese and Romaji name handling, and controlled updates.

1. What I Am Building

I am building one official international website for Chito-Ryu.

The website will make it clear who represents Chito-Ryu, where approved dojos are located, who the teachers are, and where members or visitors can find official information.



Main goal

Chito-Ryu should have one clean, controlled, and searchable international website that can be trusted by students, teachers, country leaders, and people looking for an official dojo.

What I will not build first

I will not start with the shop, videos, paid member areas, or extra automation. Those can be added later after the official website, directory, and approval process are working properly.

2. What Other Karate Organisations Already Have

I reviewed international websites from other karate organisations. The useful pattern is clear: major karate groups already show official branches, dojos, leadership, events, and rules.

Organisation type reviewed	Common features found	What Chito-Ryu should take
Shito-Ryu international sites	Official branches, country listings, instructor names, rank records, lineage information.	Approved branch and dojo directory. Leadership and lineage must be clear.
Shotokan / ISKF / SKIF / JKA	Dojo finder, member organisations, events, rules, leadership, seminars, and official group search.	World directory, event pages, rules pages, and approved contacts.
Goju-Ryu / IOGKF	International leadership, member countries, mission, news, seminars, and ownership of official name/logo.	Strong international identity, leadership, history, and official ownership notes.
Wado-Ryu and other branch sites	Regional representatives, country contacts, events, and dojo pages.	Simple country pages and dojo pages that are easy to maintain.

Recommendation: Chito-Ryu should not copy every feature. The first build should only take the necessary parts: official identity, directory, teachers, leadership, history, news, events, rules, contact, and SEO structure.

3. What the First Website Should Include

Website part	Purpose	Include now?
Home page	Introduce Chito-Ryu and direct visitors to the right pages.	Yes
Leadership and history	Present the Chito-Ryu lineage and official leadership clearly.	Yes
Dojo directory	Let people find approved dojos by country and location.	Yes
Teacher listings	Show approved teachers and their details.	Yes
Japanese and Romaji names	Show Japanese names properly with readable Romaji beside them.	Yes
News and events	Publish official updates, seminars, travel schedule, and competitions.	Yes
Rules and resources	Provide official rules and public resources.	Yes
Shop	Sell uniforms, books, training material, or digital items.	Later
Videos	Host teaching videos and paid or private training content.	Later
Member portal	Private member-only content and future paid access.	Later

4. Japanese and Romaji Handling

Japanese names must stay correct. The website should show the Japanese name and the Romaji spelling beside it, so international members can read and search it.

For Mike, I would describe this simply as: **Japanese name / English spelling**.

Input	What the website stores	Public display
Japanese characters	Original Japanese name	山田 太郎 / Yamada Taro
Kana reading	Reading used to produce Romaji	やまだ たろう / Yamada Taro
Romaji spelling	Final approved spelling	Yamada Taro

Build rule

The website can suggest Romaji, but a person must approve the final public spelling before it goes live. This prevents wrong names from being published.

5. Menu Structure

The menu should be simple. Visitors should be able to understand the website without needing to know internal structure.

Main menu	What goes inside
Home	Introduction, key links, latest news, find a dojo button.
About	Chito-Ryu overview, leadership, history, lineage.
Dojo Directory	Country list, dojo search, approved dojo pages.
Teachers	Approved teacher list, rank and dojo connection.
News and Events	Official news, seminars, travel schedule, Soke Cup updates.
Rules and Resources	Public rules, forms, resources, useful documents.
Sohonbu Experience	Training information for Japan visits.
Contact	General contact, country contact path, approved inquiry forms.

Admin login: I recommend keeping admin login out of the main menu. It can sit in the footer or use a direct private link.

6. Sitemap and Page Routes

This is the clean route plan I recommend for the website.

Page	Route	Purpose
Home	/	Main entry point.
About	/about	Overview of Chito-Ryu.
Leadership	/leadership	Official leadership and lineage.
History	/history	Chito-Ryu history.
Dojo Directory	/dojo-directory	World directory landing page.
Country page	/dojo-directory/[country]	All approved dojos in one country.
Dojo page	/dojo-directory/[country]/[dojo]	Individual dojo details.
Teachers	/teachers	Approved teacher listings.
News	/news	Official updates.
News article	/news/[article]	Individual news item.
Events	/events	Seminars, competitions, travel schedule.
Rules	/rules	Rules and official public information.
Resources	/resources	Forms, documents, and public downloads.
Sohonbu Experience	/sohonbu-experience	Training in Japan information.
Contact	/contact	Contact forms and official inquiry routing.
Privacy	/privacy	Privacy information.

7. Complete Build Stack

This is the full build stack I recommend for the first website.

Area	Tool	Why I recommend it
Website build	Next.js, React, Tailwind	Fast, clean, SEO-friendly, and suitable for a large international directory.
Hosting	Vercel	Reliable hosting for this type of website and simple deployment.
Content editor	Sanity	Lets approved people update pages, news, history, and resources without editing code.
Directory database	Supabase Postgres	Stores countries, dojos, teachers, approvals, and access records properly.
Login and access	Better Auth	Secure login for Ross, Mike, Sohonbu, and approved admins.
Email sending	Resend	Sends invite emails, contact form messages, and approval notices.
Website protection	Cloudflare	Helps protect the website and improve loading speed.
Design	Figma	Gil can prepare the UI/UX design before development.
SEO tracking	Google Search Console, Google Analytics, Vercel Analytics	Adrian and I can track indexing, traffic, page speed, and SEO issues.
Shop later	Stripe	Only needed if Mike approves the shop phase later.
Videos later	Cloudflare Stream	Only needed if Mike approves video hosting later.

8. Build Plan

Stage	What I will do	Who is involved
1. Access and content	Get domain access, website access if any, brand files, official dojo list, leadership content, teacher list, and contact details.	Mike / Ross
2. UI/UX design	Prepare clean page designs and directory layout.	Gil / Ross / Mike approval
3. SEO planning	Plan page titles, descriptions, sitemap, redirects, and search structure.	Adrian / Ross
4. Website build	Build the public website, directory, teacher pages, admin access, and contact forms.	Ross
5. Review and approval	Mike reviews the website on a private preview link before it goes live.	Mike / Ross
6. Launch	Connect domain, submit sitemap to Google, test contact forms, and monitor launch.	Ross / Adrian

9. Access I Need From Mike

To start the build, I need the following:

Access / material	Why I need it
Domain access for chitoryukaratedo.com	So I can point the domain to the new website when ready.
Current website or hosting access, if there is one	So I can check if anything needs to be preserved or redirected.
Official logo and brand material	So Gil and I can keep the design consistent.
Official country and dojo list	So the directory starts from approved information only.
Leadership and history text	So official pages are accurate.
Teacher and rank list	So teacher pages do not rely on guesswork.
Approved photos	So only permitted images appear online.
Main contact email	So inquiry forms go to the correct person.

Domain note: From the meeting, Mike was checking the domain and asked what access I need. The simple answer is: I need domain registrar access or delegated access to manage the domain records.

10. Approval Points

Before I proceed, I need Mike to approve these points.

Decision	Recommended approval
Which dojos appear first?	Only approved Chito-Ryu / ICKF-connected dojos.
Who can publish changes?	Sohonbu / Mike approval first. Country leaders can submit updates, but not publish directly at launch.
How teacher ranks are shown?	Only verified ranks should be public.
Languages for first build?	English first, with Japanese/Romaji name support. Additional language pages after content is reviewed.
Shop and videos?	Future phase only, after the official website and directory are live.

My recommendation

I recommend we start with the official website, directory, teacher list, Japanese/Romaji support, contact forms, and SEO foundation. Once Mike approves the structure, I can proceed with the build and coordinate with Adrian for SEO and Gil for UI/UX.